

1. Purpose

To discuss some of the Microsoft contract types and their use.

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3. Programs

3.1. CSP

The Microsoft Cloud Solution Provider (CSP) program enables partners to manage their customers' entire Microsoft cloud lifecycle. Through this program, partners can directly provision, manage, and support customer subscriptions using dedicated in-product tools. CSP partners can choose between two models: the indirect model, where they work with an indirect provider for support and billing, and the direct-bill model, where they handle sales, billing, and support autonomously. This program helps partners deepen customer engagements, increase profitability, and offer tailored solutions.

See: [Cloud Solution Provider program overview - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)

3.2. Pay-As-You-Go

Microsoft Azure's Pay-As-You-Go pricing model allows users to access and utilize Azure services without any upfront commitment or long-term contracts. This flexible payment option charges users only for the resources they consume, making it ideal for businesses and developers who need scalable and cost-effective cloud solutions.

The Pay-As-You-Go pricing model is available directly from Microsoft and through the CSP program.

See: [Pay-As-You-Go | Microsoft Azure](#)

3.3. Microsoft Online Subscription Program (MOSP)

The Microsoft Online Subscription Program (MOSP) is a subscription-based Microsoft Volume Licensing program designed for organizations with five or more users. It allows these organizations to subscribe to, activate, provision, and maintain Microsoft Online Services seamlessly and affordably. MOSP offers flexibility and is ideal for any type of organization looking to integrate online services into their operations. Products available through MOSP include Microsoft Office 365, Windows Azure, Microsoft Dynamics CRM Online, and Windows Intune.

4. Agreements

4.1. Microsoft Customer Agreement (MCA)

The Microsoft Customer Agreement is a transactional licensing agreement for commercial, government, and academic organizations with one or more users/devices seeking to acquire cloud services through self-service purchases or outsource management of their cloud services through a partner in the Cloud Solution Provider program. Cloud Solution Provider partners offer an easy way to license the cloud services you need in combination with the value-added services offered by your systems integrator, hosting partner, or reseller partner. On-premises software without Software Assurance is also available through partners in the Cloud Solution Provider program.

Also called Microsoft Cloud Agreement (MCA)

4.2. Microsoft Partner Agreement (MPA)

The Microsoft Partner Agreement (MPA) is a unified, digitally accepted contract for all partners in the Microsoft Cloud Solution Provider (CSP) program. It consolidates several previous agreements, such as the Microsoft Cloud Reseller Agreement (MCRA) and the Microsoft Cloud Distributor Agreement (MCDA). The MPA includes a core set of perpetual terms designed to support data privacy, security, compliance, and sound business practices. It aims to simplify the contracting experience while ensuring regulatory obligations are met and fostering trust among Microsoft, its partners, and customers.

See: [The Microsoft Partner Agreement \(MPA\) for CSP - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)

See: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/partner-center/enroll/microsoft-partner-agreement>

4.3. Microsoft Enterprise Agreement (EA)

Microsoft Enterprise Agreement and Microsoft Enterprise Subscription Agreement are commitment-based licensing agreements for commercial organizations signing a new enrollment with 500 or more users/devices* and government organizations with 250 or more users/devices. These agreements work best for organizations that want to license Microsoft on-premises software and cloud services organization-wide, over a three-year period, and at the best available pricing.

Enterprise Enrollment, Enterprise Subscription Enrollment, and Server and Cloud Enrollment (SCE) allow committed customers to standardize broadly on one or more user technologies from Microsoft. Software Assurance is included.

See: [Enterprise Agreement | Microsoft Volume Licensing](#)

4.4. Microsoft Customer Agreement - Enterprise (MCA-E)

The Microsoft Customer Agreement - Enterprise (MCA-E) is a streamlined, digital licensing agreement designed for large organizations. It simplifies the purchasing process by allowing enterprises to buy Azure services, cloud solutions, and software licenses under a single, flexible agreement that doesn't expire. This agreement offers automated processing, dynamic updates to terms, transparent pricing, and enhanced billing management capabilities, making it easier for enterprises to manage their Microsoft services and costs efficiently.

4.4.1. Key Differences between EA and MCA-E

Commitment: EA requires a long-term commitment, while MCA-E offers a flexible, pay-as-you-go model.

Management: EA involves a dedicated account manager, whereas MCA-E is managed digitally.

Renewal: EA needs periodic renewal, but MCA-E does not expire.

4.5. Microsoft Online Subscription Agreement (MOSA)

Microsoft Online Subscription Agreement (MOSA) is a transactional licensing agreement for commercial, government, and academic organizations with one or more users/devices. MOSA works best for organizations that want to subscribe to, activate, provision, and maintain cloud services seamlessly and directly via the web through the Microsoft Online Subscription Program (MOSP). On-premises software and Software Assurance are not available through MOSA. MOSA has deprecated in favor of the MCA.

4.6. Microsoft Services Provider License Agreement (SPLA)

Microsoft Services Provider License Agreement (SPLA) is for service providers and ISVs who want to license eligible Microsoft products to host software services and applications to end customers. SPLA provides the license rights to host specific Microsoft products monthly for a three-year term, as outlined in the Microsoft Service Provider Use Rights (SPUR) with pricing based on use rights.

See: [Licensing Options: Service Providers | Microsoft Volume Licensing](#)

4.7. Microsoft Products and Services Agreement (MPSA)

Microsoft Products and Services Agreement (MPSA) is a transactional licensing agreement for commercial, government, and academic organizations with 250 or more users/devices. MPSA works best for organizations that want to license Microsoft on-premises software, cloud services, or both as needed—with no organization-wide commitment and multi-year subscription options under a single, non-expiring agreement. Software Assurance is optional.

See: [Microsoft Products & Services Agreement | Microsoft Volume Licensing](#)

4.8. Microsoft Open Value

Microsoft Open Value and Microsoft Open Value Subscription are Microsoft Volume Licensing agreements for organizations with 5–499 users/devices that want to license Microsoft on-premises software, cloud services, or both.

Open Value non-company-wide is a transactional agreement. Software Assurance is included.

Microsoft Contract Types



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Open Value company-wide and Open Value Subscription are commitment-based agreements for commercial and government organizations that want to license organization-wide over a one or two-year period. Software Assurance is included.

See: [Microsoft Open Programs](#) | [Microsoft Volume Licensing](#)

4.9. Microsoft Cloud Reseller Agreement (MCRA)

The Microsoft Cloud Reseller Agreement (MCRA) was a contract between Microsoft and a company that qualified to participate in the Microsoft Cloud Solution Provider (CSP) program. This agreement allows the company to resell Microsoft cloud services and products to end customers. It outlines the terms and conditions for reselling, including the responsibilities of both parties, the use of Microsoft trademarks, and compliance with regulatory requirements. The MCRA was designed to facilitate a streamlined and efficient process for companies to offer Microsoft cloud solutions to their customers.

This agreement has been depreciated and was replaced by the MPA.

4.10. Microsoft Cloud Distributor Agreement (MCDA)

The Microsoft Cloud Distributor Agreement (MCDA) was a contractual framework designed for partners in the Cloud Solution Provider (CSP) program. It allowed these partners to distribute Microsoft cloud services to their customers. Under the MCDA, distributors manage billing, provisioning, and support for the cloud services they offer, ensuring a streamlined and efficient process for end customers.

This agreement has been depreciated and was replaced by the MPA.

5. Associated Documents

- [Microsoft Licensing Agreements](#)
- [Onboard to the Microsoft Customer Agreement \(MCA\) - Microsoft Cost Management | Microsoft Learn](#)
- https://download.microsoft.com/download/1/F/5/1F5357DD-F7C8-4CC8-8C5F-7F6B1569ECF0/Transactional_Licensing_Comparison_Chart.pdf
- [Microsoft Product Terms](#)

6. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

7. Document Revision History

Number	Effective Date	Revision History	Author
1.0	9/12/2024	Initial Draft	David Bloom